

Lithuania

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** March 20, 1989 **Usage:** National and Civil

*Green
symbolizes
the forests and
renewed hope*



*Yellow
represents
wheat and
freedom from
want*

*Red symbolizes
patriotism and courage*

Europe



After declaring independence from Russia in 1918, **Lithuania** was again occupied by the Soviet Union in 1940. It declared independence in 1991.

The national flag dates from the independent republic of 1918–1940. It was suppressed under the Soviet regime, but was re-adopted in 1990. Yellow is said to stand for ripening wheat, green for the forests, and red for love of the country, or alternatively for the blood shed in defence of the nation. Red also

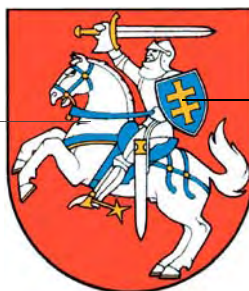
refers to the color of the medieval banners of the kingdom of Lithuania. Together, the colors stand for hope, courage and freedom from want.

ARMS OF LITHUANIA

The coat of arms' red shield dates from the 14th century. It was re-adopted in 1991.

ARMS OF LITHUANIA

*A white knight
on his charger*



*The double-barred cross
commemorates the conversion
of Grand Duke Jaggelon of
Lithuania to Catholicism
in 1386, at the time of his
marriage to Queen Hedwig
of Poland*